written by

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FROM SELF TO CHRIST



TRUE LIGHT ACADEMY

Course One

From Self to Christ

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Scripture Quotations

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TRUE LIGHT ACADEMY

Welcome to True Light Academy

Dear Friend,

Welcome to True Light Academy.

It is a joy and a privilege to welcome you to this journey of discipleship in Jesus Christ. This course was born from years of searching, questioning, praying, studying God's Word, and discovering a life-changing truth: true transformation is not found by trying harder, but by knowing Christ more deeply.

Course One is not simply a collection of Bible lessons. It is an invitation to walk with Jesus.

Together we will discover who we are in Christ, learn how God transforms the heart and renews the mind, understand His Kingdom, follow Him daily, abide in His presence, bear the fruit of the Spirit, shine His light, love others, make disciples, live by faith, persevere through every season, and ultimately live for the glory of God.

My prayer is that these pages will do more than increase your knowledge. I pray they will draw you into a deeper relationship with Jesus Christ and encourage you to become a faithful disciple who reflects His life to the world.

Welcome to the journey. May Christ, the True Light, lead every step you take.

Berhanu Aberra Tadesse

Founder, True Light Academy

Course Journey

Course One: From Self to Christ

Part One: Discovering New Life in Christ

Identity → Heart → Spirit → Mind

Part Two: Walking with Christ

Kingdom → Following → Abiding → Fruit

Part Three: Living the Life of a Disciple

Light → Love → Mission → Faith → Perseverance → God's Glory

Course Introduction

Many people know about God, yet few truly understand who they are in Christ. Lasting transformation begins when truth renews the mind and reveals our identity through Jesus Christ.

This course is designed to help you discover biblical truth, understand God's kingdom principles, and grow in a life that reflects Christ. Each lesson builds upon the previous one, leading you from knowledge to understanding, from understanding to faith, and from faith to practical living.

Take your time with each lesson. Allow God's Word to speak to your heart, and invite the Holy Spirit to guide your understanding. As you continue this journey, my prayer is that Christ becomes increasingly visible in your life and that His light shines through you to the world.

How to Use This Course

This course is designed to guide you step by step into a deeper understanding of God's truth and a transformed life in Christ.

To receive the greatest benefit:

1. **Study one lesson at a time without rushing.**
2. **Read every Scripture carefully before continuing.**
3. **Take time to reflect on the questions at the end of each lesson.**
4. **Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to reveal Christ through His Word.**
5. **Apply what you learn in your daily life before moving to the next lesson.**
6. **Review previous lessons whenever necessary.**
7. **Review previous lessons whenever necessary.**

The goal of this course is not merely to gain knowledge but to experience genuine transformation through the truth of God's Word.

May the Lord lead you as you walk in His light.

Part One – Discovering New Life in Christ

Lesson One

The Greatest Discovery: Who Am I?

Theme Verse

"So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."

(Genesis 1:27)

Introduction

Before we can understand God, we often ask another question: Who am I?

Every person wrestles with this question, whether they realize it or not. Some find their identity in success. Others find it in wealth, education, relationships, nationality, career, or religion. But none of these can fully answer the deepest question of the human heart.

The Bible teaches that our identity is not something we create—it is something we receive from our Creator.

If we misunderstand who we are, we will misunderstand why we exist. If we misunderstand why we exist, we will spend our lives searching for meaning in places that can never satisfy the soul. The journey toward Christ begins with discovering who God created us to be.

1. Created in the Image of God

The Bible begins with an astonishing truth. Human beings are different from everything else God created. Mountains display His power. The stars display His greatness. The oceans display His majesty. But humanity alone was created in His image.

Being created in God's image means that we were made to know Him, love Him, reflect His character, and enjoy fellowship with Him. Our value does not come from what we own or accomplish. Our value comes from the One who created us. Every human life has dignity because every person bears the image of God.

2. The Tragedy of Losing Our Identity

Although humanity was created for fellowship with God, sin entered the world. Sin did more than separate us from God. It distorted how we see ourselves. Instead of living as God's children, people began searching for identity in temporary things. Some pursue acceptance. Others pursue power. Others pursue pleasure. Still others pursue recognition. Yet even after achieving these things, many still feel empty. **Why?** Because the human heart was created for God. Nothing less can satisfy it.

3. Jesus Restores Our True Identity

The good news of the Gospel is not merely that our sins can be forgiven. It is that our identity can be restored. Through Jesus Christ we are invited into a new relationship with God.

Scripture declares: "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; the old has passed away; behold, the new has come." (2 Corinthians 5:17)

Our past no longer defines us. Our failures no longer define us. Our achievements no longer define us. Christ defines us. In Him we become children of God, loved by the Father and called to reflect His character in the world.

Reflection

Take a few quiet moments and consider these questions:

Where have I looked for my identity?

What has shaped the way I see myself?

Do I truly believe my worth comes from being created and loved by God?

What would change in my life if I fully embraced my identity in Christ?

Write your thoughts in a journal before moving to the next section.

Life Application

This week, whenever you find yourself measuring your value by success, failure, or the opinions of others, pause and remind yourself: **"My identity is found in Jesus Christ, not in my circumstances."** Allow this truth to shape your thoughts, decisions, and relationships.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for creating me in Your image and loving me with an everlasting love. Forgive me for searching for my identity in things that cannot satisfy. Help me to see myself as You see me. Through Jesus Christ, restore my heart, renew my mind, and teach me to live as Your child. May my life reflect Your goodness and bring glory to Your name.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Key Takeaway

True transformation begins when we stop defining ourselves by the world and begin seeing ourselves through the eyes of our Creator.

The True Light Principle:

You will never fully understand your purpose until you discover your identity in Christ.

Lesson Two

Understanding the Human Heart

Theme Verse

"The good person out of the good treasure of his heart produces good, and the evil person out of his evil treasure produces evil, for out of the abundance of the heart his mouth speaks."

(Luke 6:45)

Introduction

Why do people say things they later regret? Why do we sometimes know what is right but still choose what is wrong? Why do fear, pride, anger, jealousy, and selfishness seem to rise from within us?

The Bible points us to the heart. In Scripture, the heart is far more than our emotions. It is the center of our inner life—the place where our thoughts, desires, choices, and affections come together. Everything we do flows from it.

If our hearts remain unchanged, lasting transformation will never take place. We may change our behavior for a season, but sooner or later, the true condition of the heart will reveal itself.
Jesus did not come merely to improve our actions. He came to transform our hearts.

1. The Heart Is the Source of Our Life

The Bible teaches:

"Keep your heart with all vigilance, for from it flow the springs of life." (Proverbs 4:23)

Every decision begins in the heart before it appears in our actions. Our words reveal our hearts. Our attitudes reveal our hearts. Our priorities reveal our hearts. Our choices reveal our hearts. This is why God looks beyond appearances. While people often judge by what they can see, God examines what no one else can see—the heart.

2. A Broken Heart Cannot Heal Itself

Many people try to solve inner problems by changing outward circumstances. They think: "If I had more money..." "If I had a better job..." "If people treated me differently..." "If I lived somewhere else..." Yet even when circumstances improve, the emptiness often remains.

Why?

Because the deepest problem is not around us—it is within us. Only God can heal what sin has broken. Only God can give us a new heart.

3. God's Promise Is a New Heart

One of God's most beautiful promises is found in the book of Ezekiel:

"I will give you a new heart, and a new spirit I will put within you." (Ezekiel 36:26)

God does not merely repair the old heart. He gives us a new heart through Jesus Christ. As we trust Him, the Holy Spirit begins changing our desires. We start loving what God loves. We begin turning away from what separates us from Him. This transformation is often gradual, but it is real. Day by day, Christ shapes us into His likeness.

Reflection

Spend a few moments quietly considering these questions:

What attitudes or desires most often influence my decisions?

Are there areas where I have focused only on changing my behavior instead of allowing God to change my heart?

What would it look like to surrender my heart completely to Christ?

How is God inviting me to trust Him with the deepest parts of my life?

Write your thoughts in your journal and pray honestly before God.

Life Application

Throughout this week, before making an important decision, pause and ask yourself:

"Is this decision coming from a heart that is seeking God, or from fear, pride, selfishness, or personal desire?"

Invite the Holy Spirit to guide your heart before you act.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

You know my heart better than I know it myself. Thank You for loving me despite my weaknesses and failures. Search my heart, reveal anything that keeps me from You, and create within me a heart that delights in Your will. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit so that my thoughts, words, and actions may reflect the character of Jesus Christ. Transform me from the inside out, for Your glory.

In Jesus' name,

Amen.

Key Takeaway

True change begins in the heart. When God transforms the heart, the life follows.

The True Light Principle

God is not merely changing what you do; He is transforming who you are by giving you a new heart.